

IIM Mumbai - MBA in Creative Industries (Media & Entertainment) Mock

Time: 1 Hour | Maximum Marks: 100

Question Distribution

- **VARC:** 7 questions (suggested time 18 min)
- **DILR:** 6 questions (suggested time 14 min)
- **QA:** 7 questions (suggested time 16 min)
- **General Awareness:** 5 questions (suggested time 12 min)
- Total: 25 questions | MCQ 25 | TITA (non-MCQ) 0

Marking Scheme

- MCQ: +4 for a correct answer, -1 for a wrong answer.
- Unanswered questions: no marks awarded or deducted.

General Instructions

- Read each question carefully before attempting.
- For MCQs, choose the single most appropriate option (A-D, or A-E where shown).
- Total duration is 1 Hour; the suggested per-section times are shown above.
- Sections may be attempted in any order; manage your time across all sections.

This is the answer-marked verification copy (correct option in green, with solution) and mirrors the content of the upload CSV.

Section: VARC (suggested 18 min)

Instructions (VARC-RC): study the shared passage below and answer its 4 question(s).

For much of the twentieth century, cultural gatekeepers such as radio programmers, magazine editors, and festival curators decided which songs, films, and stories reached a mass audience. Their judgments were fallible and often narrow, but they were visible: a listener could name the DJ who championed a band, and could argue with the choice. The recommendation engines that now govern streaming platforms have inherited this gatekeeping power while shedding its accountability. An algorithm does not defend its selections in an editorial column; it simply presents them, ranked, as though they were the neutral output of preference itself.

This shift has been sold to audiences as liberation. Where the old gatekeepers imposed a single taste on everyone, the argument runs, personalisation returns choice to the individual. Yet personalisation is not the absence of curation but its intensification. Every autoplay, every 'because you watched' row, is a wager the platform makes about what will keep a user engaged, and engagement, not aesthetic merit, is the metric being optimised. The system rewards work that resembles what a viewer has already consumed, quietly narrowing the field of the discoverable even as it appears to widen it.

Creators feel the pressure. A musician learns that a track must announce its hook within seconds or lose its place in the queue; a filmmaker learns that ambiguity, which asks a viewer to wait, is penalised by a metric that reads waiting as disengagement. None of this is dictated by an editor with a name. It emerges from the aggregate behaviour of millions, laundered through code into something that feels like destiny. The danger is not that machines have bad taste, but that they dissolve the very idea of taste as a thing one can contest.

Q1. [VARC-RC · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Which of the following best captures the main idea of the passage?

- A) Musicians must now place a song's catchiest hook within its opening seconds to survive in the streaming queue.
- B) Recommendation engines ultimately fail because the machines running them possess demonstrably poor aesthetic judgment.
- C) Streaming platforms have genuinely democratised culture by handing aesthetic choice back to individual listeners and viewers.
- D) Algorithmic curation has inherited gatekeeping power while shedding the accountability that once made it contestable. ✓

Answer: D) Algorithmic curation has inherited gatekeeping power while shedding the accountability that once made it contestable.

Solution: The passage's central claim is that recommendation algorithms took over gatekeeping while dropping accountability, and that personalisation intensifies rather than removes curation. The hook-in-seconds point is only a supporting detail, so it is too narrow. The democratisation claim is the view the author critiques, not endorses. The poor-taste reading is explicitly rejected, since the author says the real danger is not bad machine taste but the dissolving of contestable taste.

Q2. [VARC-RC · mcsc · diff 0.5]

According to the passage, all of the following are supported EXCEPT:

- A) Engagement, rather than aesthetic merit, is the metric these platforms set out to optimise.
- B) The system tends to reward work resembling what a viewer has already chosen to consume.
- C) It credits recommendation engines with truly widening the range of discoverable work. ✓
- D) Twentieth-century gatekeepers were visible enough that a listener could name and dispute them.

Answer: C) It credits recommendation engines with truly widening the range of discoverable work.

Solution: The passage states gatekeepers were visible and open to dispute, that engagement rather than merit is optimised, and that the system rewards work resembling prior consumption. It never credits the engines with genuinely widening discovery; it says they only appear to widen the field while quietly narrowing it, so that claim is the unsupported one.

Q3. [VARC-RC · mcsc · diff 1]

Which of the following can most reasonably be inferred from the passage?

- A) Streaming platforms deliberately conceal the identities of the engineers who design their algorithms.
- B) A choice no one is accountable for is harder to contest than one tied to a named person. ✓
- C) Audiences would, on balance, prefer a return to centralised cultural gatekeeping.
- D) Past editorial gatekeepers chose work purely on the basis of its aesthetic merit.

Answer: B) A choice no one is accountable for is harder to contest than one tied to a named person.

Solution: The passage stresses that old gatekeepers had names one could argue with, while algorithms present ranked choices that no one defends. From this the reader can infer that an unaccountable selection is harder to contest. The passage calls past gatekeepers narrow, so it does not claim they chose on merit alone; it never says audiences want centralisation, nor that engineers' identities are deliberately hidden, since it locates the effect in aggregate behaviour rather than concealment.

Q4. [VARC-RC · mcsc · diff 1]

The author's primary purpose in the passage is to:

- A) offer creators practical guidance for gaining visibility in recommendation queues
- B) trace the full history of cultural gatekeeping from early radio through to streaming
- C) celebrate the personalisation that streaming platforms now offer to individual users
- D) warn that automated curation erodes the idea of taste as something open to dispute ✓

Answer: D) warn that automated curation erodes the idea of taste as something open to dispute

Solution: The closing lines warn that the real danger is the dissolving of taste as something one can contest, so the purpose is a warning about accountability. The author critiques rather than celebrates personalisation, offers no how-to advice for creators, and mentions radio only in passing rather than setting out to trace a full history.

Q5. [VARC-JUMBLE-1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Four sentences below form a coherent paragraph but are given out of order.

- (1) Yet the format's low production cost has also flooded feeds with thousands of near-identical shows.
- (2) Podcasting began as a niche pursuit for hobbyists recording in spare bedrooms.
- (3) Within a decade, major studios and broadcasters were commissioning series with budgets to rival television.
- (4) Standing out, as a result, now demands the very polish the medium once promised to make unnecessary.

Select the correct order.

- A) 3214
- B) 2341
- C) 2134
- D) 2314 ✓

Answer: D) 2314

Solution: Sentence 2 introduces podcasting's niche origins and must open the paragraph. Sentence 3 continues that timeline as studios arrive within a decade. Sentence 1's 'Yet ... also' contrasts the low-cost flood with those large budgets, so it follows 3. Sentence 4's 'as a result' then concludes that standing out now needs polish. Only 2314 places the contrast and result connectors after the ideas they depend on.

Q6. [VARC-ODD-1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Four of the sentences below share a common theme; one does not belong.

- (1) A memorable brand slogan compresses a company's promise into a phrase a customer can recall instantly.
- (2) Logos work by attaching a simple visual mark to the diffuse feelings a product evokes.
- (3) Jingles exploit the ear's tendency to retain a melody long after the words are forgotten.
- (4) Efficient warehouse layouts cut the distance workers walk while assembling each shipment.
- (5) Even a brand's chosen colours are calibrated to trigger particular associations in a viewer's mind.

Which sentence is the odd one out?

- A) Sentence 4 ✓
- B) Sentence 3
- C) Sentence 2
- D) Sentence 1
- E) Sentence 5

Answer: A) Sentence 4

Solution: The sentences on slogans, logos, jingles, and colours all describe branding cues that lodge associations or memories in a customer's mind. The warehouse-layout sentence is about operational efficiency and worker movement, not brand perception, so it is the misfit among the five.

Q7. [VARC-SUMMARY-1 · mcsc · diff 1]

When a film is remade for a foreign market, translators must decide how much of the original's cultural texture to preserve. Keep every local reference intact, and the new audience may feel excluded by jokes and allusions it cannot parse. Strip them all away, and the story loses the specificity that made it feel true in the first place. The most successful adaptations tend to occupy a middle ground, replacing references that would baffle viewers while retaining enough of the source's flavour to keep it recognisably itself. Localisation, in this view, is less a technical act of substitution than an editorial judgment about which meanings can travel and which must be rebuilt.

Which option best summarises the paragraph?

- A) A film inevitably loses whatever originally made it distinctive the moment it is adapted for audiences overseas.
- B) Localising a film balances preserving the original's specificity against making it intelligible to a new audience. ✓
- C) The finest adaptations faithfully keep every cultural reference from the source so the story remains fully authentic.
- D) Translators working on remade films should strip out any local reference a foreign audience might be unable to follow.

Answer: B) Localising a film balances preserving the original's specificity against making it intelligible to a new audience.

Solution: The paragraph frames localisation as a balancing judgment between keeping the original's specificity and staying intelligible to a new audience, which the balanced summary captures. Stripping every reference reflects only one horn of the dilemma, so it is too narrow. Claiming films always lose distinctiveness overreaches, since the passage says the middle ground succeeds. Keeping every reference contradicts the point that this excludes the new audience.

Section: DILR (suggested 14 min)

Instructions (DILR-1): study the shared data below and answer its 3 question(s).

The table below shows the streaming viewership (in million hours) of four StreamNet original titles across three years.

Title	2022	2023	2024
Nova Nights	120	150	180
Riftline	80	100	130
Kavya	200	250	300
Meridian	150	180	240

Q8. [DILR-1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

What was the combined viewership of all four titles in 2024, in million hours?

A) 850 ✓

B) 550

C) 780

D) 680

Answer: A) 850

Solution: Adding the 2024 column gives $180 + 130 + 300 + 240 = 850$ million hours. The 680 figure is the 2023 total and 550 is the 2022 total, so both use the wrong year.

Q9. [DILR-1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

By what percentage did Kavya's viewership grow from 2022 to 2024?

A) 150%

B) 66.7%

C) 50% ✓

D) 33.3%

Answer: C) 50%

Solution: Kavya rose from 200 to 300 million hours, an increase of 100 on a base of 200, which is 50%. The 150% trap divides 300 by 200, while 33.3% wrongly uses 300 as the base.

Q10. [DILR-1 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Which title recorded the highest percentage growth in viewership from 2022 to 2024?

A) Kavya

B) Riftline ✓

C) Nova Nights

D) Meridian

Answer: B) Riftline

Solution: Riftline grew from 80 to 130, a rise of 62.5%, ahead of Meridian at 60%, Kavya at 50% and Nova Nights at 50%, so Riftline grew fastest despite its small absolute numbers.

Instructions (DILR-2): study the shared data below and answer its 3 question(s).

Five short films (Ember, Frost, Gale, Halo and Iris) were ranked first through fifth by a festival jury, where first is the best. No two films shared a rank. The following are known:

- Gale scored higher than every other film. - Frost scored lower than every other film. - Iris was ranked immediately above Ember. - Halo was ranked immediately below Ember.

Q11. [DILR-2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

Which film was ranked third?

A) Ember ✓

B) Halo

C) Iris

D) Frost

Answer: A) Ember

Solution: Gale is first and Frost is last, so Iris, Ember and Halo fill ranks 2, 3 and 4 as a consecutive block with Ember in the middle, making Ember third.

Q12. [DILR-2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

How many films were ranked between Gale and Halo?

- A) 1
- B) 0
- C) 3
- D) 2 ✓

Answer: D) 2

Solution: Gale is ranked 1 and Halo is ranked 4, so ranks 2 and 3, held by Iris and Ember, lie between them, giving exactly 2 films.

Q13. [DILR-2 · mcsc · diff 1]

The jury awarded 92, 85, 79, 71 and 60 points to the films ranked first through fifth respectively.

What was the combined points total of Iris and Halo?

- A) 156 ✓
- B) 145
- C) 150
- D) 164

Answer: A) 156

Solution: Iris is ranked second with 85 points and Halo is ranked fourth with 71 points, so together they total 156. Using the third-place 79 for either film yields the 164 or 150 traps.

Section: QA (suggested 16 min)

Q14. [QA-MCQ-1 · mcsc · diff 0]

A shirt is marked at Rs 800. A festive sale offers a flat 15% discount on the marked price. What does a customer actually pay for the shirt?

- A) Rs 120
- B) Rs 720
- C) Rs 680 ✓
- D) Rs 920

Answer: C) Rs 680

Solution: A 15% discount keeps 85% of the marked price, so the customer pays 800 times 0.85, which is 680. The 720 value wrongly applies a 10% discount, 920 adds the 15% instead of subtracting it, and 120 is only the discount amount, not the price paid.

Q15. [QA-MCQ-2 · mcsc · diff 0]

An amount of Rs 540 is divided between Anil and Bina in the ratio 4 : 5. How much money does Bina receive?

- A) Rs 300 ✓
- B) Rs 108
- C) Rs 270
- D) Rs 240

Answer: A) Rs 300

Solution: The ratio 4 : 5 gives 9 equal parts, so each part is 540 divided by 9, which is 60. Bina's 5 parts come to 300. The 240 value is Anil's 4 parts, 270 splits the total in half, and 108 divides 540 by 5 by ignoring the ratio sum.

Q16. [QA-MCQ-3 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

A train 200 metres long completely crosses a platform 250 metres long in 18 seconds. What is the speed of the train in kilometres per hour?

- A) 25 km/h
- B) 40 km/h
- C) 90 km/h ✓
- D) 50 km/h

Answer: C) 90 km/h

Solution: To cross the platform the train covers its own length plus the platform, that is 200 plus 250, or 450 metres in 18 seconds, giving 25 metres per second. Multiplying by 3.6 yields 90 km/h. The 50 uses only the 250 platform length, 40 uses only the 200 train length, and 25 forgets to convert metres per second to km/h.

Q17. [QA-MCQ-4 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

A sum of Rs 12,000 is invested at 10% per annum, compounded annually. What is the compound interest earned at the end of 2 years?

- A) Rs 2,520 ✓
- B) Rs 14,520
- C) Rs 2,400
- D) Rs 1,200

Answer: A) Rs 2,520

Solution: The amount after 2 years is 12000 times 1.1 squared, which is 12000 times 1.21, or 14520, so the interest is 14520 minus 12000, that is 2520. The 2400 value is the simple interest for two years, 1200 is only one year of interest, and 14520 is the maturity amount rather than the interest.

Q18. [QA-MCQ-5 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

A 40 litre mixture of milk and water contains milk and water in the ratio 3 : 1. How many litres of water must be added so that the ratio of milk to water becomes 3 : 2?

- A) 20 litres
- B) 10 litres ✓
- C) 15 litres
- D) 5 litres

Answer: B) 10 litres

Solution: In the 40 litre mixture the milk is 30 litres and water 10 litres. Keeping milk fixed at 30, a 3 : 2 ratio needs water equal to 30 times two thirds, that is 20 litres, so 20 minus the existing 10 gives 10 litres to add. The 20 is the final total water not the amount added, 15 and 5 come from mishandling the ratio.

Q19. [QA-MCQ-6 · mcsc · diff 1]

A committee of 3 people is chosen at random from a group of 4 men and 3 women. What is the probability that the committee contains at least 2 women?

- A) 1/35
- B) 22/35
- C) 13/35 ✓
- D) 12/35

Answer: C) 13/35

Solution: The total ways to pick 3 from 7 is 35. Exactly 2 women gives $C(3,2)$ times $C(4,1)$, that is 12, and exactly 3 women gives 1, so at least 2 women is 13 out of 35. The 12/35 counts only the exactly-two case, 1/35 counts only all women, and 22/35 is the complement taken from a wrong favourable count.

Q20. [QA-MCQ-7 · mcsc · diff 1]

How many integers from 1 to 200 inclusive are divisible by 3 or by 5 but not by 15?

- A) 80 ✓
- B) 93
- C) 53
- D) 106

Answer: A) 80

Solution: Multiples of 3 up to 200 number 66, of 5 number 40, and of 15 number 13. By inclusion and exclusion, divisible by 3 or 5 is 66 plus 40 minus 13, that is 93, and removing the 13 multiples of 15 leaves 80. The 93 forgets to exclude the 15 multiples, 106 skips inclusion and exclusion, and 53 subtracts only once.

Section: General Awareness (suggested 12 min)

Q21. [GA-1 · mcsc · diff 0]

In advertising, the abbreviation 'TVC' most commonly stands for:

- A) Total Viewer Coverage
- B) Television Viewership Certificate
- C) Television Commercial ✓
- D) Targeted Video Campaign

Answer: C) Television Commercial

Solution: TVC is standard trade shorthand for a Television Commercial, the paid advertising spot aired during television programming. Total Viewer Coverage, Targeted Video Campaign and Television Viewership Certificate are invented expansions not used in the industry.

Q22. [GA-2 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

The long-running advertising tagline 'Just Do It' belongs to which brand?

- A) Reebok
- B) Puma
- C) Adidas
- D) Nike ✓

Answer: D) Nike

Solution: The 'Just Do It' slogan was launched by Nike in 1988 and remains one of the most recognised taglines in advertising history. Adidas, Puma and Reebok are competing sportswear brands that have used entirely different slogans.

Q23. [GA-3 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

The classic 'four Ps' of the marketing mix are:

- A) Product, Price, People and Positioning
- B) Product, Price, Place and Promotion ✓
- C) Product, Position, People and Promotion
- D) Price, Place, Packaging and Publicity

Answer: B) Product, Price, Place and Promotion

Solution: The marketing mix popularised by E. Jerome McCarthy comprises Product, Price, Place and Promotion. Alternatives that substitute People, Position, Packaging or Publicity describe extended or misremembered frameworks, not the original four Ps.

Q24. [GA-4 · mcsc · diff 0.5]

In the media and entertainment industry, the term 'OTT' stands for:

- A) Over-The-Transponder
- B) Over-the-Top ✓
- C) Online Transmission Technology
- D) On-The-Television

Answer: B) Over-the-Top

Solution: OTT stands for Over-the-Top, meaning film and television content delivered directly to viewers over the internet, bypassing traditional cable and broadcast distribution, as with streaming platforms. The other expansions are not real industry terms.

Q25. [GA-5 · mcsc · diff 1]

Which award is the highest honour presented at the Cannes Film Festival?

- A) Golden Globe
- B) Golden Bear
- C) Golden Lion
- D) Palme d'Or ✓

Answer: D) Palme d'Or

Solution: The Palme d'Or, or Golden Palm, is the top prize awarded to the best film at the Cannes Film Festival. The Golden Lion, Golden Bear and Golden Globe are the leading honours of the Venice festival, the Berlin festival and the Hollywood awards respectively.